

Chapter 126-4

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Her entire being was plummeting at high speed, her soul losing its weight.

After falling for who knows how long, she landed in a vast expanse of thick fog.

Clusters upon clusters of fog shrouded her on all sides—she couldn't see anything.

Voices kept coming through.

"Jiejie, let's get out of here."

"Wuwuwu, jiejie, I'm scared."

"Jiejie, stop smiling, they'll hit you."

"Jiejie, do you have any wishes?"

"Jiejie, look! Fireflies!"

"I heard that if you make a wish on fireflies, the wish will come true. Jiejie, what did you wish for?"

"I hope to have lots and lots of love."

"..."

A young child's voice rang in her ears, and all those memories carried by the wind returned to her mind.

In that abandoned factory, a group of children were trapped there. The kidnappers called their parents demanding ransom, saying they would kill them if no ransom was paid.

The kidnappers sat together in twos and threes, smoking and drinking while fantasizing about the future.

Because she smiled too much, they knocked out her front teeth.

They were a bunch of inhuman things.

But even more inhuman than them was—after she was kidnapped and they called her parents demanding ransom—Qiu Zimin's ice-cold voice.

Qiu Zimin said: "Kill her then."

Those three words left an indelible shadow in the young child's heart.

Many memories came flooding in. The scenes were still vivid, except the scenes of being kidnapped were covered with a layer of gray—as if memories she never wanted to recall in this lifetime were being dredged up again.

In her memories there were also green grass and fresh flowers, laughter and joy, but more of it was darkness and fear.

Soon, the thick fog enveloped her again.

Two little girls huddled together for warmth in the abandoned factory. She had learned from Qi Jiao to always carry White Rabbit milk candies¹ with her, and she secretly slipped one to the little sister in the factory.

She led the little sister to escape together. They held hands, and the wind blew up their hair and skirts.

She comforted the little sister: "Don't be afraid, I'm here."

Actually, she herself was scared to death too.

They ran until they were gasping for breath, but didn't dare stop—looking for all the world like they were fleeing for their lives.

The memories from before age eight that had been sealed away were almost all remembered now.

The dust-covered past was taken out again, surprising Liang Shi.

Liang Shi suddenly thought of Xu Qingzhu's strange way of breaking up the word, "Jiejie"

She was the only one who had that strange pause when calling "jiejie."

Yet it was also exceptionally familiar and pleasant to hear.

Because that was how she called it when she was little, calling it again and again.

The thick fog was about to swallow her whole. Everything in sight was white, as if a heavy snow had fallen.

"Liang Shi... A-Shi..."

Someone in the distance was calling her name. Liang Shi wanted to open her mouth to respond, but found she couldn't speak at all.

She opened her mouth, but her throat felt like it was stuffed with cotton—she couldn't say anything.

Liang Shi could only keep walking forward, walking toward the direction of the voice.

But ahead was a vast expanse of fog. She couldn't see the path, and the voice seemed to come from near and far.

Which way should she go?

Liang Shi felt so tired.

She wanted to find Xu Qingzhu. Xu Qingzhu's shrill voice from that night still echoed in her ears—she didn't know how she was doing now.

Once this ended, she would have her own body.

She could stand in front of Xu Qingzhu and say openly and honestly: "I am me."

She could embrace and kiss without any burden, and tell her: "I remember you now, little Zhuzi."

Liang Shi had so many, many things she wanted to say to her.

She walked forward aimlessly, her stamina giving out, and collapsed in the vast fog.

As her consciousness scattered, that familiar eerie mechanical voice came again: 【Bzzt... bzzt...】

It was still that sound like an electric drill, making Liang Shi's scalp tingle, wishing she could smash her own head open.

The static sound only lasted a few seconds, but for Liang Shi it was extreme torture.

【Host... program... error... bzzt...】

The mechanical voice was intermittent, saying a few words before crashing again.

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1. White Rabbit milk candies (大白兔奶糖) - A famous Chinese milk candy brand that has been popular since the 1940s. The candies are known for their creamy, milky taste and their distinctive white wrapping with a blue and red rabbit logo. They are a nostalgic treat for many Chinese people and are often associated with childhood memories. ↵